

Software Engineer

Part-time summer contractor · Remote · Starts June 1, 2026

About JoyNet

JoyNet is a social media platform built around curated, positive short-form video. The product combines a content feed, real-time messaging, community spaces, and integrated research tooling. Behind the scenes, an automated pipeline ingests and processes content from major social platforms with minimal human intervention.

The Role

We are hiring one part-time engineer to work directly alongside the founder on day-to-day product development. The work spans the full stack: frontend features and fixes, backend API work, data pipeline maintenance, and light ML and data tasks. Expect to wear many hats. On any given week you might triage a frontend rendering bug in the morning, debug a data ingestion job in the afternoon, and ship a small feature improvement the next day.

This is a hands-on builder role. You will own real production code, push fixes that users see, and have meaningful input on technical direction. A significant portion of the work is bug investigation and resolution across the stack.

What You'll Do

- Investigate and fix bugs across the React frontends, the Node and Express API layer, and the Python data pipeline.
- Build and ship new product features end-to-end, from UI to backend.
- Improve reliability, observability, and performance of the automated content pipeline.
- Touch ML-adjacent code: data preprocessing, model serving, evaluation tooling, and inference performance.
- Review and discuss architectural decisions, and contribute to technical planning.

What We're Looking For

- Strong general software engineering fundamentals. Clean code, version control with Git, and disciplined debugging.
- Comfort moving across the stack. You don't need to be an expert in every layer, but you should be willing to read unfamiliar code and ramp up quickly.
- Working knowledge of React and modern JavaScript.
- Working knowledge of Python and at least one backend framework (Express, Flask, FastAPI, or similar).
- Familiarity with cloud platforms and serverless concepts. GCP or AWS experience is fine.
- Self-direction. You can take a vague bug report and drive it to resolution without hand-holding.

Nice to Have

- Experience with Firebase or Firestore.
- Exposure to ML workflows: PyTorch, Hugging Face, or general model training and inference.
- Prior work on data pipelines, ETL, or scraping systems.
- Frontend design sensibility and a careful eye for UX detail.

Logistics

START DATE June 1, 2026	DURATION Summer term, with potential extension into fall
HOURS ~10 hours per week, flexible scheduling	COMPENSATION \$20 per hour
LOCATION Remote	EQUIPMENT Bring your own development machine

Contact

Reach out directly to discuss the role, see a deeper technical overview, and walk through next steps.